File No: 22003/05/2023/NCVET
National Council for Vocational Education and Training
Ministry of Skill Development and Entrepreneurship
Government of India

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Subject: Inviting Public Comments- Draft Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) Guidelines

1. The National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, emphasizes on ensuring lifelong learning for everyone. As per the NEP, 2020, "The opportunity to attain foundational literacy, obtain an education, and pursue a livelihood must be viewed as basic rights of every citizen. Literacy and basic education open up whole new worlds of personal, civic, economic, and lifelong-learning opportunities for individuals that enable them to progress personally and professionally." The RPL will act as a tool to recognize the competency, skills, professional Level achieved, foundational literacy and education of an individual which are mainly acquired through either non-formal, informal or traditional modes of learning. This will enable individuals to exhibit their personal and professional capabilities in a more formal and effective way.

2. To fulfil the vision and mission of the National Education Policy 2020, a Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) guidelines has been formulated by the Government, with the introduction of a reformed RPL framework, the landscape of education and training will receive a fresh impetus. Recognizing all non-formal learning outcomes is a technique that honours and makes visible the whole range of competencies that people have acquired over the course of their life in diverse contexts and through various means. RPL serves as a motivator for the advancement of lifelong learning.

3. The guidelines on RPL addresses major components of an individual's/applicant's prior learning and also provides new verticals for RPL assessments which will be beyond the conventional methods. Below are few salient features of the RPL guidelines:

    a) Provides a roadmap for RPL implementation in the skill ecosystem.
    b) Introduction of best practices among AB and AA for RPL.
    c) Introduction of new and innovative methods for assessments including blended models of assessments
    d) Empowering of industrial bodies for conduct of RPL for their workforce
    e) RPL for traditional/indigenous skills
    f) Well proposed RPL assessment model for different NSQF levels to be accessible within and across all sectors
    g) Provision of earning credits through RPL and accumulation of credits in Accredited bank of Credits (ABC).

4. Comments/inputs/suggestions are invited on the draft document at directorpolicy.ncvet@gmail.com by 21st Feb 2023.

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GOVERNMENT OF INDIA
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NCVET
कौशल गुणवत्ता प्रगति

Draft Guidelines for Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)



27th Jan 2023 (Version- 10.2)

National Council for Vocational Education and Training (NCVET)

CONTENTS

1. INTRODUCTION 4
1.1 Overview, understanding, and importance of Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) in the Ecosystem 4
1.2 Current Scenario and Challenges 5
1.3 Need for Rationalising the RPL Policy 5
1.4 Mapping of RPL practices 6
1.5 Definitions 7
1.5.1 Formal Learning 7
1.5.2 Non-Formal Learning 7
1.5.3 Informal Learning 7
1.5.4 Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) 8
2. Scope and the Objectives of the Guidelines 8
2.1 Scope 8
2.2 Objectives 8
3. Stakeholders of Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) 9
3.1 Applicants/ Candidates/ Workers/ Beneficiaries/ Employees 9
3.2 Employers, Industry, Industrial bodies, and Community 9
3.3 Implementing bodies (ABs and AAs) 10
3.4 Sponsoring/ Funding Bodies 10
3.5 Government and Regulatory Body (NCVET) 10
4. The Process and Implementation Mechanism 11
5. Role of Awarding body (AB) 22
5.1 Critical Primary Functions with regard to RPL Assessment 22
6. Role of Assessment Agency (AA) 22
6.1 Recognition of various types of Assessors for RPL 23
6.1.1 Certified Master Assessors, and Assessors of Assessment Agencies 23
6.1.2 Industry Experts formally recognised by the Industry 23
6.1.3 Assessor in Dual role ('Trainer as Assessor' or 'Assessor as Trainer') 23
6.2 Role of Assessors in Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) of different types 23
7. Types of Assessments of Knowledge, Skills and Competency 24
8. Delivery Channels and recommended Centres/ Venues for RPL assessments 26
8.1 Awarding Bodies (AB)/ AB's Affiliated Training Provider/ Centre 26
8.2 Workplace or workshop (for traditional/ indigenous `skills) 26
8.3 RPL at Colleges/ HEIs/ Universities having vocational education/ skilling labs/ workshops facilities 26
8.4 Industrial Clusters for conducting assessment / examination / test 26
8.5 RPL at Centre of Excellence (COEs) 27
8.6 Place of employment/ on-site 27
8.7 On demand Assessment through Aggregators (online/ offline) 27

DRAFT

8.8 RPL at Schools/ Skill Hubs having vocational education/ skilling labs (for the local workforce) 27
9. Provision of RPL for Person with Disability (PwD)/ Divyangjan 27
10. Integrating RPL with NCrF 27
10.1 Assignment of credits as per National Credit Framework (NCrF) levels based on the Learning Outcomes (LOs) 28
10.2 Credit accumulation in Accredited Bank of Credits (ABC) 28
10.3 Redemption / Transfer of Credits 29
11. Quality Assurance and Quality Control (QA/QC) 29
11.1 Steps to ensure Quality Assurance 29
12. Monitoring and Evaluation (through online/ portal) 30
12.1 Process of Monitoring 30
12.2 Reporting Mechanism 30
13. Creating a dedicated RPL Digital portal in due course to support 30
14. Process for Modification/ up-dation of Guidelines from time to time 31
14.1 Guidelines issued with the approval of the Council after following due process of public consultations 31
14.2 Removal of Difficulties in implementation with the approval of the Chairperson, NCVET 31
Annexure – 1: RPL PROCESS FLOWCHART 32
Annexure – 2: THE VARIOUS USE-CASE ON THE DUAL ROLE OF ASSESSOR 36
Annexure – 3: HACKATHON BASED ASSESSMENTS 37
Annexure - 4: TRADITIONAL (INDIGENOUS) SKILLS/ OCCUPATIONS AND ITS ASSESSMENT PROCESS 38

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Guidelines for Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Overview, understanding, and importance of Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) in the Ecosystem

Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) was promoted as a social policy tool in 1972 to create "learning opportunities for the underprivileged" (UNESCO, 1972, p. 41). In 1995 the European Commission (EC) portrayed RPL as an economic policy tool for promoting employability for all (EC, 1995). Several countries have adopted RPL since it is regarded as a win-win policy for all stakeholders: adults seeking RPL, providers offering RPL, employers needing certified human resources, unions aligned with the interests of any of these stakeholders, and the state, which is responsible for citizen welfare and the economy.

In September 2012, the Ministry of HRD, Government of India initiated a pilot project on RPL as a part of the National Vocational Education and Qualification Framework (NVEQF). Subsequently, under the flagship scheme of Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY 2016-2020), RPL was introduced by the Government of India as a tailor-made program, for assessing and certifying the competencies of the existing skilled workforce.

Presently, the Vocational Education and Training/ Skilling ecosystem in India lacks a standardized policy on recognition of Prior Learning, leading to variations in the assessment standards, certification authority and credibility resulting in limited mobility for the candidate and ambiguity in the industry while comparing certificates from various types of awarding bodies.

The National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 emphasizes on ensuring lifelong learning for everyone. As per the NEP, 2020, "The opportunity to attain foundational literacy, obtain education and pursue a livelihood must be viewed as basic rights of every citizen".

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1.2 Current Scenario and Challenges

Recognition of Prior Learning is a method to assess the previous learning, functional competencies/ skills of a student/learner acquired through formal, non-formal and informal modes of learning, and is systematically evaluated against the learning outcomes and assessment criteria of a NSQF aligned and approved qualification (leading to the award of credit).

The RPL therefore, is also a method to assess whether a Learners can demonstrate to meet the assessment requirements on a job-role/qualification through knowledge, understanding of skills, they already possess and they may or may not require to undergo a defined course of learning.

It enables the recognition of achievement from a range of activities using an appropriate assessment methodology. The knowledge, understanding and/or skills in question may have been acquired in any area of life, for example, domestic/family life, education and training, work related activities, community or voluntary activities.

Currently, In India RPL is predominantly driven through signature schemes like PMKVY etc. These schemes are implemented through Public- Private and Public-Public partnerships. Additionally, RPL is normally limited to lower NSQF level skills, not giving opportunities for higher level skills acquired on the job or otherwise, to get recognised. Following are the challenges in the effective implementation of the RPL:

a) Conceptual scepticism about the definition of RPL, the purposes it serves, and lack of clarity about different RPL models and how to implement them.
b) All the Employers may not be aware about provision of RPL or may not recognize qualifications/ certificates achieved through RPL.
c) Language barrier (multi lingual support)
d) Insufficient infrastructure and tools for effective assessment of the RPL.
e) Lack of qualified counsellors, assessors, and competent staff for the conduct of RPL.
f) Challenges in RPL assessment for Indigenous/heritage/traditional skills.

1.3 Need for Rationalising the RPL Policy

With redefining of the RPL processes, the landscape of education, training and certification will receive a fresh impetus. Recognizing all non-formal learning outcomes honours and makes visible the whole range of competencies that people have acquired over the course of their lives in diverse fields and through various means. RPL serves as a motivation for honouring the lifelong learning.

RPL is needed by following target groups:

Target Groups	Needs
Craftsperson (such as electrician, mason, cook, etc.)	• They acquire competencies informally during their jobs, but do not hold any formal qualification/ certificate to prove their competencies to the employer. Thus, they get less opportunity and low wages. • Sometimes, they hold a formal qualification for the lower skill level to their actual core competencies. • They may not be aware of some of the prevalent/latest techniques which they can learn

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Any worker in the informal economy	• Need RPL to move to the formal economy
An unemployed worker	• RPL provide formal certification that could help in getting employment / self-entrepreneurship (by taking loan on basis of certificate)
An economically inactive person	• RPL certification can support the individual who used to work in an occupation without certification and excited about the labour market, and now wants to go back and find formal employment
A caretaker or a person employed in an occupation at home (mostly by women and often underpaid)	• RPL can help the individual to get a job in the labour market by providing formal certification commensurate to their competencies.
An employed person in any job where qualification requirements have changed over the years or where qualification requirements differ across countries (such as caring for the elderly, kindergarten worker, physiotherapist, etc.)	• RPL helps such person to remain competitive in the global labour market
A student, researcher, etc.	• Need RPL to get recognition for the knowledge and skills obtained during job, workshop, projects, etc. It also helps to earn credits for accumulation in Academic Bank of Credits.
A worker who wishes to continue working after retirement.	• Need RPL to get recognition for their competencies qualifications to continue working, even as self-employed.
A migrant worker or a returning migrant worker	• Need RPL to get formal recognition for their skills in the recipient country
An industry worker who has learned areas on the job	• Certification can open further career doors/ windows
An Athlete/ Sportsperson	• Need RPL to get recognition for their competencies/ skills obtained while playing games/ sports/doing handicraft work etc. • RPL would also help them to earn academic equivalence certificates at different NCrF levels.

1.4 Mapping of RPL practices

Criteria	Type
Aim	• Employability • Social equality • Social upliftment • Economic development • Career Progression • Entrepreneurship/Self-employment Database
Methods	• Written tests • Viva voce • Portfolio review • Interviews

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	• Projects/output oriented assignments / tangible Jobs • Case Studies • Competitions • Blended assessments
Outcomes	• Recognition • Full qualification certification • Partial qualification/NOS certification • Scope of Upskilling/Reskilling • Credits towards a qualification/ work • Exemption from admission prerequisites for formal education • Certification

1.5 Definitions

1.5.1 Formal Learning

Formal learning is that which takes place as intended within formally constituted educational institutions such as schools, colleges, universities, training centres and so on. Typically, it follows a prescribed framework whether or not actual attendance at the institution is necessary. (Sometimes there are quite specific outcomes. On other occasions there is more of a kind of broad direction or aim). Formal learning either is with providing specific outcomes or enables setting up a broad direction or aim for learning outcomes The concept of formal learning usually includes following three necessary features that, taken together, constitute the formality of the learning situation:

a) A specified curriculum that details out what needs to be learned and expected learning outcome.
b) Designated teacher or group of teachers for imparting training.
c) Certification after attaining the learning outcomes which can be provided post formal assessment.

1.5.2 Non-Formal Learning

As seen, formal learning has a well-defined set of features. Whenever one or more of these is absent, we may safely state that the learning process has acquired non-formal structure. Therefore, if a given learning system uses non-contiguous communication, we may say that it has non-formal learning features. Likewise, non-formal characteristics are found when the adopted strategy does not require individual attendance, reducing the need of the contact between teacher and student and most activities take place outside the institution, as for instance, home reading and paperwork or in community work.

1.5.3 Informal Learning

Informal learning is the term assigned to learning that's unstructured and takes place away from traditional, formal learning settings, like a classroom. It has no clear goals or objectives as it's often unplanned and self-directed by the learner and is not a planned way of learning. It generally happens naturally and inadvertently or during the course of job with the learner stumbling into a learning situation. It is learner driven and Informal learning comes in many forms, including **viewing videos, self-study, reading articles, participating in forums and chat rooms, performance support, coaching sessions, and games**. Informal learning is a style of learning in which the learner sets their own pace of learning, goals and objectives.

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1.5.4 Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)

RPL is an assessment process that assesses the individual's formal, non-formal and informal learning/talent to measure the individual' learning outcomes, competency outcomes, or standards for entry to the formal ecosystem, and partial or total completion of a qualification. It aims to:

a) Align the competencies of the unregulated workforce and informal way of skilling to the standardized National Skills Qualification Framework (NSQF).
b) Enhance the employability opportunities of an individual as well as provide alternative pathways to higher education.
c) Provide opportunities for bridging the inequalities based on privileging certain forms of knowledge over others.
d) Provides way for formally recognising lifelong informal learning

2. SCOPE AND THE OBJECTIVES OF THE GUIDELINES

2.1 Scope

These guidelines promote the recognition of prior/ previously acquired skills in the work skills ecosystem and also provide for planning and implementing RPL in an efficient and effective manner while ensuring the quality of enablement and outcomes. This guideline lays down the minimum standards & process to be followed for the Awarding Bodies and Assessment Agencies recognized by NCVET with regard to assessment of RPL.

These guidelines aim to facilitate NCVET recognized bodies to reach out to individuals, through proposed mechanisms for effectively assessing their skills, making it easier for learners/ individuals to integrate into the formal learning system in order to be employed (wage/self). These guidelines also provide a significant approach in strengthening the vocational and educational training system and in establishing a robust skill recognition system.

The RPL guidelines will apply to all NSQF aligned & approved qualifications and will also form an integral component of National Credit Framework. Thus, RPL (with or without upskilling) would enable student/learner to acquire and accumulate the credits for the qualifications for which they are assessed subject to successful clearing of the assessment. The guidelines outline a well-defined mechanism through which recognised awarding bodies would be able to:

a) Identify the commensurate /appropriate level of skills of individuals.
b) Map the skills acquired through experiential learning including work experience and professional levels, achieved with an existing NSQF aligned and approved Qualification.
c) Assess the individual on the basis of individual' learning and performance outcomes.
d) Recognition of the certificate obtained by an employer/education provider and to provide access to the labour market and/or formal education on the basis of that certificate.

2.2 Objectives

The objective of the RPL Guidelines is to provide a dynamic/robust document to support the individuals in acquiring the formal qualification(s) that matches their knowledge and skills, and thereby contributing in improving their employability, mobility, lifelong learning, social inclusion and self-esteem.

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The detailed objectives of the RPL guidelines are:

1. To **align the prior competencies** of the existing manpower/workforce with the National Skills Qualification Framework (NSQF)
2. To **formalize learning by providing progression avenues** to the Kamgars/ learner, both in terms of employment and academic attainment, if so desired, as applicable.
3. To **enhance the employability of individuals** and/or increase their ability to avail entrepreneurial opportunities
4. To provide opportunities for **reducing inequalities**.
5. To provide best practices among AB and AA for RPL
6. To enable & facilitate industrial bodies for conduct of RPL for their workforce
7. Bring in traditional/indigenous skills in the recognised formal learning.
8. Provision of earning credits and accumulation of credits in Accredited bank of Credits (ABC).
9. To develop the potential to **improve employability, mobility, lifelong learning, social inclusion and self-esteem** through:
    a. Promoting social inclusion and equity for marginalised/disadvantaged groups including early school leavers, retrenched Kamgars, ethnic minorities – by valuing experiential learning and providing them with opportunities to obtain qualifications.
    b. Encouraging lifelong learning in order to create a competent and adaptable workforce that can meet the challenges of a fast-changing environment, address skills gaps and allow holistic development.
    c. Providing access and opportunity for further education.
    d. Improving efficiency and flexibility in education and in the skilling ecosystem by allowing alternative learning pathways which can enable formal, non-formal, and informal learning and fast tracking the acquisition of qualifications.
    e. Fostering employability, and thus better, jobs with better pay.
    f. Contributing to the transition from the informal to the formal economy.

3. STAKEHOLDERS OF RECOGNITION OF PRIOR LEARNING (RPL)

3.1 Applicants/ Candidates/ Workers/ Beneficiaries/ Employees

A nationally recognised and credible qualification brings numerous benefits for an applicant/candidates/ workers/ beneficiaries/ employees, including:

a) Access to formal education, training programmes and promoting lifelong learning.
b) Opportunity in getting better jobs, move into the formal economy, or qualify to function as a professional.
c) Eligibility or access to apply for Government Bids/tenders and financial services for businesses, thus improving business potential.
d) Improved self-esteem and respect in society with the associated process of certification
e) Improvement in skills and the requisite knowledge as many individuals may require upgrading of their skills and the knowledge thereof in order to meet the competency standards.

3.2 Employers, Industry, Industrial bodies, and Community

Having a qualified and certified human resource in any requisite skill is generally an organizational requirement that helps the organization to acquire quality assurance certifications. A workforce with upgraded skills and knowledge would be more productive and will contribute to innovation and Return on Investment (ROI). Besides, it improves the morale of Kamgars/employees and promotes a positive learning culture.

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3.3 Implementing bodies (ABs and AAs)

All NCVET recognised Awarding Bodies and assessment Agencies shall have the mandate for the effective implementation of the RPL assessment and subsequent certification as per this Guideline.

3.4 Sponsoring/ Funding Bodies

Central Ministries/Other Govt. Departments/States/Public & Private Sector Companies through CSR projects, NGOs others). Another similar bodies may facilitate conduct of RPL assessment through recognised entities as per para 3.3 above.

3.5 Government and Regulatory Body (NCVET)

- NCVET may amend/add the various regulating parameters for RPL as per the advisories from MSDE and other inputs received from various potential stakeholders in the skill ecosystem.
- Establish a National advisory committee for RPL
- Mobilise resources for RPL implementation
- To develop the Process and Implementation Mechanism to ensure quality and relevance of the RPL process.
- To monitor and evaluate the implementation of RPL in the ecosystem.

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4. THE PROCESS AND IMPLEMENTATION MECHANISM

The RPL mechanism is designed keeping in mind the NCrF/ NSQF; the process encompasses different NCrF/ NSQF levels and approach to be adopted by the Awarding Bodies. For the purpose of clarity in processes required for implementation, the RPL process is divided in four major categories, the table specifies the various steps and involved process. The process at different NCrF/ NSQF levels is proposed in the table below:

NCrF/ NSQF Level / Stages	Level 1-3.5	Level 4-6 (12th with experience, UG-PG Pursuing)	Level 4-6 (without formal education)	Level 6.5-8 (PG and PhD)
Stage 0 **Choosing Type of Assessors**	**1.** Assessors/Proctors [Certified by Training of Assessors (ToA) programs]	1. Master of trade 2. Master Assessors 3. Industrial Experts 4. Assessor/Proctors [Certified by Training of Assessors (ToA) programs]	1. Master of trade 2. Master Craftsman 3. Master of Traditional / Heritage Skill 4. Skill Gurus 5. Ustads 6. Master Assessors [Certified by Training of Master Assessors (ToMA) programs]	1. Technical Review Committee (formed by the Awarding Bodies/Institutions)
Planning Methods of Evaluation/ Assessment	1. Hands on skill assessment to be done only in the physical mode 2. Objective type Question for theory assessment 3. Blended methods of evaluation *(Note: The objective questions may be asked as viva voce in the local language of the individual/ candidates)*	1. Hands on skill assessment can be done in the physical mode/ blended mode 2. Subjective type questions for theory assessment 3. Objective type Question for theory assessment 4. Viva voce 5. Projects/ Skill demonstration 6. Hackathon	1. Hands on skill assessment can be done in the physical mode/ blended mode 2. Online/blended assessment 3. Objective type Question for theory assessment 4. Viva voce/Interview	1. Review of prior work achievements 2. Letter of recommendations by state or central govt. or institute of repute 3. Practical/ hand-on skill Assessment

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NCrF/ NSQF Level / Stages	Level 1-3.5	Level 4-6 (12th with experience, UG-PG Pursuing)	Level 4-6 (without formal education)	Level 6.5-8 (PG and PhD)
Stage 1 ***Awareness***	**Awareness and Mobilization** ➢ Campaigns shall be designed to create awareness about RPL program and its need and benefits ➢ These campaigns shall catalyse the mobilization of the candidates for RPL. Strategy: ➢ Identification of target group ➢ Public notice / advertisement at National/ State/ Regional/ Local level through various means of **mass awareness** such as: Print Media, Electronic media, outdoor advertising, Direct Interaction with prospective candidates,	**Awareness and Information** ➢ The potential candidates shall be made aware about RPL as an opportunity. ➢ ABs/ AAs shall use various marketing strategies to create a **pull force** in the market resulting in higher enrolments for the RPL program. Strategy: ➢ Identification of target group ➢ Publicity / Advertising to the reach of target group ➢ Viral marketing through successful stories ➢ Word of mouth (online & offline) ➢ Social Media	**Awareness and Information** ➢ The potential candidates shall be made aware about RPL as an opportunity. ➢ ABs/ AAs shall use various marketing strategies to create a **pull force** in the market resulting in higher enrolments for the RPL program. Strategy: ➢ Identification of target group ➢ Advertising as per the reach of target group ➢ Viral marketing through successful stories ➢ Word of mouth (online & offline) ➢ Social Media	**Awareness and Application** ➢ Awareness campaigned shall be undertaken to inform about RPL program for level 6.5 to 8, and to make reach among the potential candidate ➢ The campaign shall create awareness about the application process for the RPL program. Strategy: ➢ Advertising ➢ Word of mouth (online & offline) ➢ Social Media

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NCrF/ NSQF Level / Stages	Level 1-3.5	Level 4-6 (12th with experience, UG-PG Pursuing)	Level 4-6 (without formal education)	Level 6.5-8 (PG and PhD)
	Community advertising (in Panchayats or workplace)			
Stage 2 ***Enrolment***	**Pre-screening and counselling** ➢ In this step, the mobilized candidates shall be enrolled and briefed about RPL processes, entry criteria, benefits of RPL, career progression, employability, opportunity to enter into formal education, etc. All candidates must undergo 12-15 hrs of **orientation**. ➢ Further, candidates shall be pre-screened to determine their tentative NSQF level and then method of assessment i.e. either by **"Direct assessment**" or **"Upskilling followed by Assessment".**	**Self-enrolment and verification** ➢ The candidates shall be allowed/ encouraged to get **self-enrolled**/ registered for the RPL program. ➢ All documents submitted by the candidates during enrolments shall be verified by AA for authenticity. ➢ All enrolled candidate shall be provided with 4 to 15 hrs. of **mandatory orientation.** ➢ An approximate NSQF level of the candidate shall be estimated (either by **self-assessment** or by assessor) ➢ During enrolment if the candidate is found unsuitable, then they may take related upskilling module/course(s) and thereafter they may appear for RPL assessment	**Enrolment and verification** ➢ The candidates shall be guided for the enrolment/ registered for the RPL program. ➢ All documents submitted by the candidates during enrolments shall be verified by AA for authenticity. ➢ All enrolled candidate shall be provided with 4 to 15 hrs. of **mandatory orientation.** ➢ An approximate NSQF level of the candidate shall be determined by an assessor. ➢ During enrolment if the candidate is found unsuitable, then they may take an upskilling module/course and thereafter they may appear for RPL assessment	**Pre-screening and applicant profile evaluation** ➢ Pre-screening of the candidate's profile shall be done to ascertain the suitability of the candidate as per the NSQF level and work experience. ➢ The suitable candidate is further evaluated and directed either to **"Technical Review Committee"** or to **"upskilling/ orientation program followed by RPL assessment"**.

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NCrF/ NSQF Level / Stages	Level 1-3.5	Level 4-6 (12th with experience, UG-PG Pursuing)	Level 4-6 (without formal education)	Level 6.5-8 (PG and PhD)
Stage 3 ***Assessment***	**Process of assessment** • **Direct assessment:** The mapping of candidate's experiential learning outcomes is equal or more than 70% of qualification learning outcomes. (Note: Guidelines for Direct assessment are provided in the AA guidelines.) • **Upskilling followed by assessment:** If, the mapping of candidate's experiential learning outcomes is less than 70% of qualification learning outcomes, then candidate shall require taking up an upskilling module or earning a NOS/ Micro credential before the assessment. Upskilling prior to the assessment shall also be	**Assessment (Theory + Practical + Viva-voce)** ➢ Assessment of Theoretical Knowledge through online mode/ platform: weightage may vary from 30% to 50% (based on sector/ job role/ qualification). ➢ Assessment of practical skills based on work experience in physical mode (online mode can be adopted for certain suitable job roles): weightage may vary from 50% to 70%. ➢ The weightage for the assessment through Viva-voce may vary from 0% to 10%.	**Assessment (Theory + Practical + Viva-Voce)** ➢ Assessment of practical skills based on work experience in physical mode: (weightage may vary from 80% to 100%. ➢ The weightage for the assessment through Viva-voce may vary from 0% to 20% Note: The question framed for the practical/ Viva-voce shall be based on the prior job/ project work experience in accordance with PCs of the qualifications/ NOSs. The provision for theoretical assessment can be provided for certain qualifications with weightage varying from 0 to 10%.	**Process of assessment** • **Technical review committee** evaluates the candidates with significant and long lasting contribution to the sector, industry, country, or to the individual's discipline or profession. • **Upskilling/ orientation with assessment** are recommended for the candidates with outstanding work profile and field experience in their professional discipline.

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NCrF/ NSQF Level / Stages	Level 1-3.5	Level 4-6 (12th with experience, UG-PG Pursuing)	Level 4-6 (without formal education)	Level 6.5-8 (PG and PhD)
	allowed where there is an obvious skill gap due to the change in technology, futuristic skills and advancement of work place/ methods.			
Governance Process to be used for Assessment	➢ The questions framed for the assessment (by any mode) should be based on prior job/ project work experience in accordance with the performance criteria's (PCs) of the National Occupational Standards (NOSs). ➢ Each RPL batch strength shall be of maximum 20 candidates. ➢ The assessment may be performed in a group or individually, but every candidate must be assessed for the practical skills. ➢ Every assessment shall be proctored and supported with digital and video evidences with geotagging.	➢ The questions framed for the assessment (by any mode) should be based on prior job/ project work experience in accordance with the performance criteria's (PCs) of the National Occupational Standards (NOSs). ➢ Each RPL batch strength shall be of maximum 20 candidates. ➢ The assessment may be performed in a group or individually, but every candidate must be assessed for the practical skills. ➢ Every assessment shall be proctored and supported with digital and video evidences with geotagging.	➢ The questions framed for the assessment (by any mode) should be based on prior job/ project work experience in accordance with the performance criteria's (PCs) of the National Occupational Standards (NOSs). ➢ Each RPL batch strength shall be of maximum 20 candidates. ➢ The assessment may be performed in a group or individually, but every candidate must be assessed for the practical skills. ➢ Every assessment shall be proctored and supported with digital and video evidences with geotagging.	**For Technical Review Committee** ➢ The Technical Review Committee shall consist of at least 7 members. It shall comprise the CEO/ Head of the AB, standards head of the AB, sectoral/ industrial expert, academicians, and a member from regulating bodies. The committee shall be headed by a chairperson. ➢ A record of the data obtained from the candidate should be stored both in online and offline mode. **For Upskilling with Assessment**

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NCrF/ NSQF Level / Stages	Level 1-3.5	Level 4-6 (12th with experience, UG-PG Pursuing)	Level 4-6 (without formal education)	Level 6.5-8 (PG and PhD)
	➢ The Assessment Agencies will develop and operate an online portal/ platform to conduct practical assessments and record evidence of the assessment.	➢ The Assessment Agencies will develop and operate an online portal/ platform to conduct practical assessments and record evidence of the assessment.	➢ The Assessment Agencies will develop and operate an online portal/ platform to conduct practical assessments and record evidence of the assessment.	➢ The questions framed for the assessment (by any mode) should be based on prior job/ project work experience in accordance with the performance criteria's (PCs) of the National Occupational Standards (NOSs). ➢ Every assessment shall be proctored and supported with digital and video evidences with geotagging. ➢ The Awarding Bodies shall develop SOPS to conduct assessments and record evidence of the assessment.

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NCrF/ NSQF Level / Stages	Level 1-3.5	Level 4-6 (12th with experience, UG-PG Pursuing)	Level 4-6 (without formal education)	Level 6.5-8 (PG and PhD)
Stage 4 ***Certification and Feedback***	➢ Assessor shall analyse all the evidences and answer sheets to prepare the result of the candidates. ➢ The successful candidates shall be awarded with certificates, qualifications, credits, etc. ➢ The unsuccessful candidates shall be guided for proper training programs ➢ Every candidate shall be requested for feedback about the RPL program.	➢ Assessor shall analyse all the evidences and answer sheets to prepare the result of the candidates. ➢ The successful candidates shall be awarded with certificates, qualifications, credits, etc. ➢ The unsuccessful candidates shall be guided for proper training programs ➢ Every candidate shall be requested for feedback about the RPL program.	➢ Assessor shall analyse all the evidences and answer sheets to prepare the result of the candidates. ➢ The successful candidates shall be awarded with certificates, qualifications, credits, etc. ➢ The unsuccessful candidates shall be guided for proper training programs ➢ Every candidate shall be requested for feedback about the RPL program.	➢ The successful candidates shall be awarded with certificates, qualifications, credits, etc. ➢ The unsuccessful candidates shall be guided for proper training programs ➢ Every candidate shall be requested for feedback about the RPL program.

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NCrF/ NSQF Level / Stages	Level 1-3.5	Level 4-6 (12th with experience, UG-PG Pursuing)	Level 4-6 (without formal education)	Level 6.5-8 (PG and PhD)
Used Cases/ illustration for RPL	**Candidate Persona** **Name:** A **Job Designation:** Helper at construction site **Job role under RPL Program:** Assistant Scaffolder (level 2, 2.5, 3), Sector Construction **Age:** 22 **Education:** Ability to read and write **Experience:** 4 years 'A' saw a poster at his construction site and came to know about RPL program at one of the nearest skilling centre. He got to know that RPL can provide a certificate for his skills gained from work experience of 4 years in scaffolding occupation. visited the skilling centre and got enrolled in the RPL program.	**Candidate Persona** **Name:** B **Job Designation:** IT Executive (Hardware) **Job role under RPL Program:** Advance Diploma in Hardware, Networking and Information Security (level 5) **Age:** 24 **Education:** 12th Grade pass **Experience:** 4 years 'B' saw a Public notice / advertisement in on a social media platform and came to know about RPL program at one of the nearest IT skilling centre. He went to the skill centre and enrolled himself for the RPL program. He assessed himself to determine his approximate NSQF level. After enrolment, he went through the RPL assessment	**Candidate Persona** **Name:** C **Job Designation:** Assistant to head Mechanic **Job role under RPL Program:** Automobile repairing Mechanic (level 4, 5) **Age:** 25 **Education:** 5th Grade pass **Experience:** 6 years 'C' saw a public notice / Public notice / advertisement in a local newspaper and came to know about RPL program at one of the nearest skilling centre. went to the skill centre and got enrolled for the RPL program with the help of officer at skill centre. He got assessed by the assessor to determine his approximate NSQF level. After enrolment, he went through the RPL assessment	**Candidate Persona** **Name:** D **Job Designation:** Freelancer (Software Developer) **Job role under RPL Program:** PG-Diploma in Advanced Computing (Level 7) **Age:** 35 **Education:** BCA **Experience:** 10 years **Outstanding work achievement:** 'D' has successfully delivered multiple projects for MNCs. 'D' came to know about the RPL program from one of his close friend. He applied for the RPL program by submitting every relevant details/ documents of his achievement. The AB/ AA accepted the application of 'D' and his application were sent to the

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NCrF/ NSQF Level / Stages	Level 1-3.5	Level 4-6 (12th with experience, UG-PG Pursuing)	Level 4-6 (without formal education)	Level 6.5-8 (PG and PhD)
	After enrolment, he went through the RPL assessment process as described above. He was declared successful in the assessment and awarded with the RPL certificate of NCrF/ NSQF level 2.5 along with credits. **Benefits achieved:** 1. Now, 'A' can show-case his skills in form of a certificate provided by Government of India. This also clarified his further career progression. 2. 'A' went to his employer where he was appointed as "Helper" and shown his RPL certificate of	process as described above. He was declared successful in the assessment and awarded with the RPL certificate of "Advance Diploma in Hardware, Networking and Information Security (level 5)" along with the credits. **Benefits achieved:** 1. Now, 'B' can show-case his skills in form of a certificate provided by Government of India. This also provides roadmap for his further career progression. 2. 'B' went to his employer where he was appointed as "IT Executive (Hardware)" and shown his RPL	process as described above. He was declared successful in the assessment and awarded with the RPL certificate of Automobile Repairing Mechanic (level 4) along with the credits. **Benefits achieved:** 1. Now, 'C' can show-case his skills in form of a certificate provided by Government of India. This also clarified his further career progression. 2. 'C' went to his employer where he was appointed as "Assistant to head Mechanic" and shown his RPL certificate of	Technical Review Committee of the IT-ITeS Awarding Body. After assessing the profile of 'D', the committee found him suitable for the RPL assessment subject to completion of an upskilling course on emerging technologies. Subsequently, 'D' undertook an upskilling course on DevOps. Then his updated profile was presented before the committee for the final review/ assessment. 'D' was declared successful and awarded with the RPL certificate and relevant credits. **Benefits achieved:** 1. Now, 'D' can show-case his higher skills in form of a certificate provided by Government of India. 2. 'D' applied for the post of senior developer (IT) in one of the MNC for which he has earlier completed a project. He was appointed

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NCrF/ NSQF Level / Stages	Level 1-3.5	Level 4-6 (12th with experience, UG-PG Pursuing)	Level 4-6 (without formal education)	Level 6.5-8 (PG and PhD)
	Assistant Scaffolder (NCrF/ NSQF level 2.5). The employer realised his actual skills and promoted him to Assistant Scaffolder. This also increased his salary. Thus, the RPL certificate upgraded the social and financial status of 'A'.	certificate of "Advance Diploma in Hardware, Networking and Information Security (level 5)". The employer realised his actual skills and upgraded him to Network Administrator. This also increased his salary. Thus, the RPL certificate upgraded the social and financial status of 'B'.	Automobile repairing Mechanic (level 4). The employer realised his actual skill and upgraded him to Automobile repairing Mechanic. This also increased his salary. Thus, the RPL certificate upgraded the social and financial status of 'C'.	as "senior developer (IT)" with good salary package.
Flowchart	**Refer Annexure 1 Flowchart no: 1**	**Refer Annexure 1 Flowchart no: 2**	**Refer Annexure 1 Flowchart no: 3**	**Refer Annexure 1 Flowchart no: 4**

Important points to be Noted:

1. The application/ enrolment detail shall include a brief statement of the following information for each candidate:
    i. Name and pertinent personal information
    ii. Rationale for RPL certification
    iii. Supporting letters/ letter of recommendation.
    iv. Experience letter
    v. Outstanding service to the sector, industry, and/ or community if any
2. In case of the unavailability of the supporting documents such as experience certificate, the Awarding Body/ Assessment Agency may ask the candidate to self-declare Individual work experience in the form of an affidavit and conduct an aptitude test before allowing the candidate to appear for the RPL assessment.
3. The orientation program/ course shall include sensitization sessions on employability skills, career progression, domain skills, and familiarization with RPL program, assessment processes and methods. During this session, the candidates must be explained about the learning outcomes of the qualifications.

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NCrF/ NSQF Level / Stages	Level 1-3.5	Level 4-6 (12th with experience, UG-PG Pursuing)	Level 4-6 (without formal education)	Level 6.5-8 (PG and PhD)
4. The Awarding body/ Assessment Agency shall provide guidelines/ SOPs and support to promote self-assessment among the candidates. 5. The assessment shall be conducted in a transparent and fair way ensuring that all the candidates get equal opportunities. 6. The Awarding Bodies may identify qualifications/ job roles on which online practical assessment could be possible and provide guidelines for conduct of the same in online mode.				

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5. ROLE OF AWARDING BODY (AB)

5.1 Critical Primary Functions with regard to RPL Assessment

An awarding body (AB) is an entity, recognized by the NCVET to award certification to trainees/ learners for NSQF Aligned and Approved qualification by ensuring quality training and reliable assessments. The AB has an important role with regard to conduct of RPL Assessment and Certification which are enumerated below:

a) Identifying and Listing of relevant Learning Outcomes of the qualification for the RPL assessments to be carried out
b) Defining roles of accredited RPL advisor/counsellor
c) Enlistment of State/GOI/ Industry recognised/ decorated Master Craftsmen, Masters of Trade, Heritage/ Tradition Skill Masters, Skill Gurus, Ustads for specific skills
d) Identification of various RPL delivery channels and establishing their credibility.
e) On-boarding of NCVET recognised assessment agencies to ensure fair and reliable assessments through pre-defined norms and processes.
f) Development of norms for training of specialized assessors for RPL programs as per the sector specifications.
g) Empanelment of subject Matter Experts (SMEs), Industrial Experts, Master of trades, and Master Assessors, which shall be used for RPL qualification/ curriculum validation and assessment processes.
h) Affiliation and accreditation of training partners for the implementation of RPL.
i) Monitoring of RPL processes.
j) Award RPL certification to the learners in NSQF aligned and approved qualification.
k) Set up a system of redressing grievances.
l) Progressively develop and enhance capacity to implement RPL in accordance with this policy and any specific requirements by NCVET
m) Ensure that they have the necessary staff capacity to deliver quality RPL services and programmes
n) Ensure effective planning and funding for RPL administrative and logistical systems to support all programmes and services
o) Put systems and procedures in place to incentivise and support the registration and continuing professional development of RPL assessors

6. ROLE OF ASSESSMENT AGENCY (AA)

Assessment Agency is defined as an agency which tests or conducts examinations to assess whether a learner has met the requirements necessary to be competent and qualified with respect to a skill or qualification. Functions of an AA with respect to RPL assessment are as mentioned below:

a) Develop RPL assessment strategy, Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)/ checklists for question bank development, assessment analytics, roles and responsibilities of the assessors, proctors and SMEs, etc.
b) Ensure availability of accessible standardized assessment tools across languages and learner groups.
c) Ensure availability of Industrial Experts, Master of trade, Master Assessors, Assessors and proctors who are trained in delivering of RPL.
d) Allocate appropriate Assessors (Industrial Experts/ Master of trade/ Master Assessors/ certified Assessors and proctors) to the RPL assessment batch.
e) Conduct quality assured standardized RPL assessment and upload/ record the evidence and results.

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6.1 Recognition of various types of Assessors for RPL

6.1.1 Certified Master Assessors, and Assessors of Assessment Agencies

Master Assessors, Assessors and proctors are the skilled professionals who are trained to assess RPL learners/ batches on the NSQF aligned and approved qualifications. They are recognized and certified by Awarding Bodies on the basis of pre-defined parameters by NCVET. Further details may be available in the ToA guidelines prepared by NCVET.

6.1.2 Industry Experts formally recognised by the Industry

An industry expert preferably is from within a particular industry, who possesses invaluable insight, expertise, and valuable information in his domain. They can be directly empanelled by the ABs/ AAs for the assessment of RPL batches. The services of these experts can be availed by paying them remuneration on either hourly basis or batch wise at the discretion of AB/ AA and as mutually agreed upon.

6.1.3 Assessor in Dual role ('Trainer as Assessor' or 'Assessor as Trainer')

Trainer as Assessor: In case of Awarding Bodies (dual categories) which can perform both training and assessments within their campus/ institution, the trainers/ instructors can also act as an assessor.

Assessor as Trainer: In some cases, an assessor can act as a Trainer also. The assessor may not provide training on the full qualification, but they can provide training for orientation programs or for some NOS/ micro-credential based training.

Note: the various use-cases on the dual role of assessor are attached at Annexure-2.

6.2 Role of Assessors in Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) of different types

a) Assesses and evaluate Applicants/individual's RPL against the learning outcomes as defined.
b) Ensures evidence with respect to authenticity, credibility, reliability and integrity.
c) Ensures that applicant has met more than 70% of all the declared learning outcomes for direct RPL assessments
d) Ensures that applicant presented has met the knowledge, skills and competency elements of the qualification.
e) The assessor will score and grade the evidence in accordance with the scoring and grading mechanisms established for the qualification. If a qualification is described in unit standards and their specific outcomes, then the assessment criterion for those outcomes must be satisfied.

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7. TYPES OF ASSESSMENTS OF KNOWLEDGE, SKILLS AND COMPETENCY

Method	Description
Testing of Theoretical knowledge through online/offline/ Blended mode (oral/ written tests, Multiple choice, subjective Qualifications, examination)	The purpose of assessment of theoretical knowledge is to evaluate cognitive skills or measure achievement of learning outcomes and competence outcomes, and provide information for more effective evaluation. A number of methods can be used to assess the retention of theoretical knowledge following training. These can be paper based or part of the e-Learning programme.
Testing of Practical/ hands on skills/ Skill Demonstration	The described methods evaluate the candidates for their motor skills learnt from experiential learnings.
Job work, projects, assignments, role play, practical examinations	The methods assess the candidates for the effective application of theoretical and practical skills in the actual working conditions as Apprentice, On-Job Training, projects, etc.
Skill demonstrations, product assessments and/ or simulations	Simulation provides a virtual environment analogous to the actual environment to demonstrate the necessary skills. This method can be useful for highlighting areas of relative strength and weakness and may be used to improve the curriculum to address missing components.
Group practical tests	This would test the teamwork ability of the candidate. This would evaluate the candidates on the various parameters of the group dynamics.
Oral viva-voce on Practical/ hands on skills	Oral viva-voce is an assessment conducted, in which a candidate provides their response to the given task in verbal mode (instead of writing). Under this method, the candidates can be asked to explain the concepts, methods, process, etc. associated to their practical/ hand on skills.
RPL in Higher Level Skills: 360-degree assessments	360-degree assessment is a performance management tool intended for employees to get multisource feedback about work performance and improvement areas. In a 360-degree evaluation, the person being reviewed receives feedback from people with whom he/she works. These reviews may come from peers, subordinates, direct reports, teammates, and even external parties, such as vendors and clients, called Raters in the process.
Blended Assessment methods	This type of assessments is based on various learning patterns, which could be vocational, class room based, collaborative learning methods (online or offline). Various

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	Assessments can be combined as needed to get a final outcome result. For example, LMS based Proctored content delivery tool with in-built continuous/ formative/summative assessment to check learning outcomes. These types of assessments rely on technological advances, which can include virtual labs etc.
Achievements/Awards based evaluation	In this type of assessment, an individual/candidate/learner is evaluated based on the long lasting / established contribution to the society, sector and industry etc. For example: An individual who has represented India at the International level competition and achieved Gold /Silver/ Bronze medal then the individual may be considered and evaluated for certain type of RPL assessment and certification *in the same domain.*
Hackathon Based Assessments	Hackathons are intense, time-bound events wherein people collaborate in groups to solve significant challenges. Through the process, participants will generate innovative and practice-oriented ideas for authentic, sustainable assessment approaches to add to their Knowledge. *Kindly refer to **Annexure-3** for detailed methodology*

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8. DELIVERY CHANNELS AND RECOMMENDED CENTRES/ VENUES FOR RPL ASSESSMENTS

8.1 Awarding Bodies (AB)/ AB's Affiliated Training Provider/ Centre

An individual can go to the Awarding Bodies/ Training centres (recognised by ABs) and can request for RPL assessments available at the centres.

8.2 Workplace or workshop (for traditional/ indigenous `skills)

NEP 2020 emphasizes rich heritage of ancient and Indian eternal knowledge and promotes the nurturing of heritage skills and furthermore emphasizes on researching, enhancing and putting new uses through our education system. Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL) for various traditional (indigenous) skills/occupation is an integral approach to acknowledge and recognise the potential of artisans and craft persons paving the way for upskilling and mainstreaming them in formal sectors. RPL on demand for various traditional (indigenous) skills/ occupation can be very effective especially for those skills **which are on the verge of extinction.**

RPL for these traditional (indigenous) skills/ occupations need special consideration due to their peculiar nature. The following points may be considered:

a) These skills use traditional hand tools.
b) These skills usually take a long period to produce a product or complete a job as per the required quality.
c) These skills are practiced only by few people (indigenous people)/ families.
d) Typically, there is no formal learning pathway for these skills. These are passed on from one generation to another.
e) Industrialization/ scaling of these skills are generally not possible.

Most of these skills require a special delivery channel for RPL assessment in which the RPL can take place at the residence of the worker/ worker's workshop.

The detailed information regarding traditional (indigenous) skills/ occupations and its assessment process is attached at Annexure 4.

8.3 RPL at Colleges/ HEIs/ Universities having vocational education/ skilling labs/ workshops facilities

Colleges/ universities form one of the most important delivery channels which can conduct/ operate the RPL scheme to recognise prior learning for admission and/ or credit equivalence. There may be some prospective students who would not be able to provide the necessary evidence to meet the school/ college/ university's entry requirement (as per admission notice publication) for the particular course/ qualification, but they are able to provide substantial and relevant alternative evidence for their potential/competency to succeed in the course/ qualification. In these circumstances, the RPL can be used to provide the relevant alternative evidence. Furthermore, RPL provision can be used by the colleges/ universities to determine the potential of the students.

RPL also allows transition from training centres to education institutions and vice-versa, and increase educational choices and career opportunities.

8.4 Industrial Clusters for conducting assessment / examination / test

It is recommended that assessments be conducted on-site at the location where kamgars/employees are available/already working in large numbers in any specific sector,

industry or traditional skills concerned. RPL in 'Skill Hub' initiatives can be considered under this delivery channel.

8.5 RPL at Centre of Excellence (COEs)

Centre of excellence for conducting RPL based assessments may be developed or identified and assessment to those may be provided by the NCVET recognised AB/AAs. The AB shall identify or develop COEs with Industry/HEIs, Industry bodies etc.

8.6 Place of employment/ on-site

This type of RPL evaluation is recommended to be carried out on site at the premises of the employers. One of the major challenges in this delivery channel modus operandi is that most of the kamgars in many sectors may work as a daily wage worker. Employers have obvious constraints and are reluctant to allow their kamgars to go for RPL assessment/ upskilling training as it causes a financial loss to them. Therefore, for such cases, a provision of 'Wage Compensation' to the employers/ workers (kamgars) may be considered to motivate both kamgars and employers. E.g., NHAI. Alternatively, in the larger interest of Learners as also the Employers a suitable/appropriate via media like time sharing/off office hours etc. may be worked out by ABs, AAs and the other stakeholders.

8.7 On demand Assessment through Aggregators (online/ offline)

This delivery channel provides opportunities to all those skill seekers who wish to take an online/ offline exam and get certified. This may also be offered as a fee-based program if the learners wish to be assessed and certified. This ideally should be offered from accredited/designated centres as per the NCVET guidelines

8.8 RPL at Schools/ Skill Hubs having vocational education/ skilling labs (for the local workforce)

The concept of RPL may also be extended to the general education domain to create options for individuals to get assessed for a subject/ qualification at same or at a higher level, subject to meeting the competency levels and concerned regulatory compliances and clearing the requisite assessment. This shall effectively provide learner with options of Exam/ Assessment on Demand. NIOS is an example which offers option of 'Exam on Demand' to learners who have completed requisite no of years of self-study/ learning for assessment for a particular educational grade. Similar models can be developed and adopted by other state school boards and CBSE etc. to provide RPL option in school education as well.

9. PROVISION OF RPL FOR PERSON WITH DISABILITY (PWD)/ DIVYANGJAN

The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 emphasizes for the inclusion of person with disability in all mainstream formal and non-formal vocational and skilling programmes. The concerned awarding bodies such as SCPwD, may create SOPs for carrying out the RPL assessment programs for the PwD Candidates.

10. INTEGRATING RPL WITH NCRF

Under the National Credit Framework (NCrF) every learning can be creditised subject to its successful assessment. The National Credit Framework (NCrF) also enables creditisation of experiential learning, based on the weightage for relevant experience and proficiency levels achieved, subject to successful assessment.

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Each level of NCrF corresponds to certain credits and credit points that can be further utilized by the candidate as per the requirements of learner. Under the "Provision of the NCrF", the assignment of credits and the credit levels are done on the basis of learning outcomes rather than on learning hours. The same principle may be applied to the RPL as under it the learners are assessed for their experiential learning outcomes against the standards (NOS) of the qualification. Thus, the assignment of credits and the credit levels under the RPL shall be similar to the those of the concerned qualification.

10.1 Assignment of credits as per National Credit Framework (NCrF) levels based on the Learning Outcomes (LOs)

Keeping in view the credit accumulation policy as per National Credit Framework (NCrF) Following principles underpin the creditisation of assessment related to RPL:

a) RPL credit may be awarded for knowledge and skills acquired through experience. The length of time and years of experience are not calculated and assessed but it is the learning outcomes of the specific skills, competencies and knowledge acquired, that is assessed and credit bearing.
b) RPL credits should only be awarded where the applicant/individual can demonstrate his/her ability to apply foundational (theoretical) and practical competence in various contexts.
c) Credits are awarded only for demonstrated competence, and not for exclusive work experience.
d) Credits must be awarded only for learning that is relevant to the content and learning outcomes of the learning programme for which the credit is applied subject to assessment.
e) Credit should be awarded only for relevant levels of learning as determined in the qualification and by the relevant assessment and quality assurance process
f) Appropriate subject matter/academic experts and assessors must make the determination of competence levels and of credit awards, when decisions are made regarding RPL assessment and certification.
g) After successful assessment of the candidate through RPL, the credits accumulated by the learner will be the same as applicable for the total number of Notional Hours and NSQF Level for the particular job role/Qualification in which the learner has undergone RPL assessment.

10.2 Credit accumulation in Accredited Bank of Credits (ABC)

The NEP 2020 proposes to establish an 'Academic Bank of Credit' (ABC) which could digitally store the academic credits earned from recognized institutions so that the degrees can be awarded taking into account credits earned.

The NCrF encapsulates provision of award of ***Credits of all learning, assignment, accumulation, storage, transfer & redemption of credits subject to assessment and removes*** *distinction and establishes academic* ***equivalence*** *between vocational & general education; enables* ***mobility*** *within & between them, and its operationalising through the Academic Bank of Credits (ABC).*

The Academic Bank of Credit shall be a repository of all credits earned by the Individual. These credits shall be accumulated and redeemable provided the credits accumulated are within the same assessment band. The credits accumulated shall have a defined validity/ expiry which will be defined w.r.t. RPL

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10.3 Redemption / Transfer of Credits

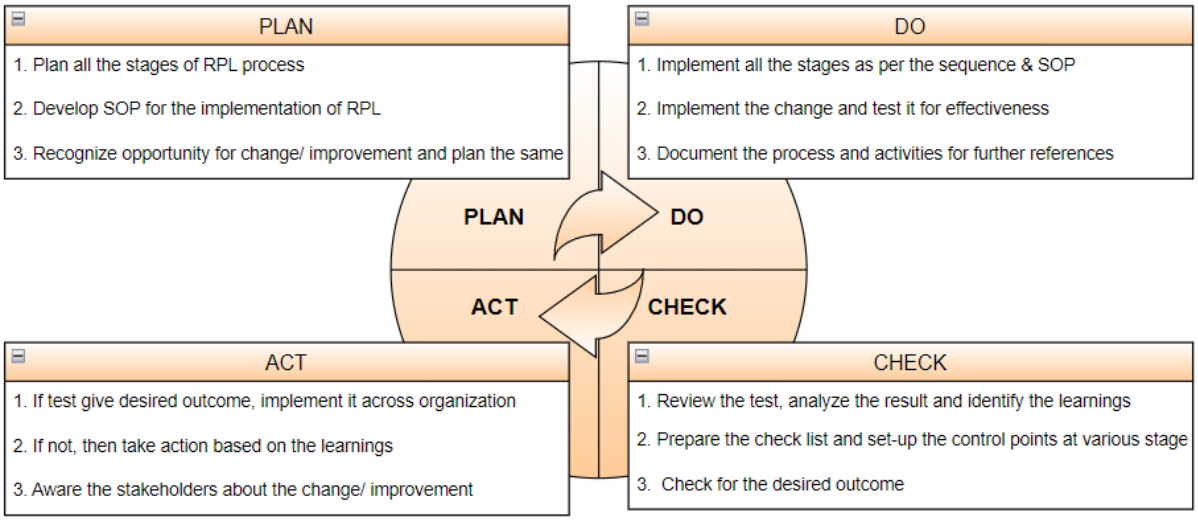
The credits earned as part of RPL assessment will be deposited to student's ABC account. After the accumulation of credits, a student can redeem these in order to get any academic degree based on the norms set by the regulatory body/ institution where the individual is planning to get a degree. It works on the principle of Multiple Entry-Multiple Exit as well as "anytime learning, anywhere learning, and any level learning' as is emphasized in NEP 2020. For credit redemption, the process to be followed will be as per the Academic Bank Guidelines notified by UGC.

11. QUALITY ASSURANCE AND QUALITY CONTROL (QA/QC)

11.1 Steps to ensure Quality Assurance

The Awarding Bodies/ Assessment Agencies are encouraged to adopt "Plan-do-check-act (PDCA) cycle" for the implementation of RPL assessment. A PDCA cycle is a four-step continuous looping process of planning, doing, checking (or studying), and acting. It is a framework that helps organisations to change and improve their processes. This method provides a simple and effective approach for solving problems and managing change. The model is useful for testing, enabling improvement measures on a small/ large scale before updating procedures and working practices.

This would assist the ABs/ AAs to frame an effective Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) for the implementation of RPL/ any other program. The model can be illustrated as below mentioned figure:



The RPL guidelines also prescribe recommendations for partner agencies/ entities working under their fold, to ensure quality in their operations too. NCVET will not directly control and monitor the partner agencies/ entities working with the AB. It will be the responsibility of the AB to ensure that the partner agencies/ entities adhere to the recommendations of the RPL guidelines. Such delegated regulations empower an AB to take punitive/ corrective action against partner agencies/ entities in cases of non-adherence to the RPL guidelines.

The AB/AA are to encourage teaching practices and approaches to RPL assessment that incorporates RPL as a component of flexible student-centred learning, and that staff

development be made available to assist teaching staff in developing these practices and approaches.

There should be transparency in the payment system among various stakeholders (Training Partners/ Centres, Assessment Agencies, Awarding Bodies, Scheme sponsoring bodies/ agencies). The payment system should be automated based on online and/ or offline evidence submission, and the turnaround time (TAT) should be fixed for every milestone.

Awarding Bodies/ Assessment Agencies should formalise a QA/ QC committee department within their organisation to monitor the quality of delivery of RPL assessment

12. MONITORING AND EVALUATION (THROUGH ONLINE/ PORTAL)

12.1 Process of Monitoring

NCVET shall monitor the RPL assessments as per the monitoring norms prescribed under the Guidelines for recognition of Awarding Bodies and Assessment Agency.

NCVET shall undertake quarterly/annual performance reviews of RPL assessment methodologies adopted by Awarding Bodies/Assessment Agencies. The quality checks will be carried out for each Awarding Bodies/Assessment Agencies. NCVET may also opt for a site visit as part of review process. The council may also ask for any information pertaining to RPL.

The Governance Process, including providing of video recordings of the assessments may be included in the process of monitoring which may further strengthen it.

12.2 Reporting Mechanism

The AB must maintain a documented policy containing a set of procedures, templates and checklists which are in consonance with the NCVET guidelines and such policy should be updated time to time. Recognized AB shall submit data on the Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) in a timely and accurate manner and any other data which may be asked from time to time, by the NCVET. The AB must establish and maintain a system of monitoring its third-party agencies and compliance reports must be submitted to NCVET as required by it.

13. CREATING A DEDICATED RPL DIGITAL PORTAL IN DUE COURSE TO SUPPORT

Today's education and learning scenario is rapidly innovating. To provide access to information specific to RPL programs, a dedicated RPL Digital portal may be set up by concerned stakeholders as a way of providing users (i.e. Students/leaners/applicants, trainers, assessors, proctors, facilitator) with information about the online/on demand RPL facilities and features. Generally, in RPL assessments, things are done manually such as enrolment, mapping of Learning outcomes, certification etc. so to automate such practices NCVET will be designing a web portal for RPL assessments, which will be helpful in following features like time saving, easy access and user friendly, etc. This portal shall provide useful facilities for Students/leaners/applicants, trainers, assessors, proctors, facilitators who wish to access the portal at one click sitting anywhere and give or access RPL assessment dashboard.

The core objective is to design, develop and maintain the RPL Portal that will enable seamless experience for learners of RPL Digital Platform to complete the entire assessment and certification process.
The scope may include:

a. Option to appear for an assessment by self-enrolment.
b. Functions to enable learners/applicant to select nearest test centres to give RPL assessment
c. Functionality to choose a date and time for Pre-screening and orientation of their convenience and then to appear for the assessment.
d. Listing of Learning Outcomes of the qualification for RPL assessments
e. Assigning of assessors/proctors to learners/applicants based on the pre-defined criteria outlined by NCVET
f. Various types of assessment facilities
g. Real time assessment results and issuance of certificates
h. Report generation and insightful analytics
i. Feedback mechanism and grievance redressal

14. PROCESS FOR MODIFICATION/ UP-DATION OF GUIDELINES FROM TIME TO TIME

14.1 Guidelines issued with the approval of the Council after following due process of public consultations

The RPL guidelines has been prepared by NCVET in consultation with all the stakeholders and then released for public consultation for the 21 days. After, the 21 days of public consultation, all the comments/ suggestions have been evaluated and incorporated as per the relevance/ requirement. Then the draft guidelines are approved by the NCVET council committee and released for the implementation.no need to mention in the Guidelines

14.2 Removal of Difficulties in implementation with the approval of the Chairperson, NCVET

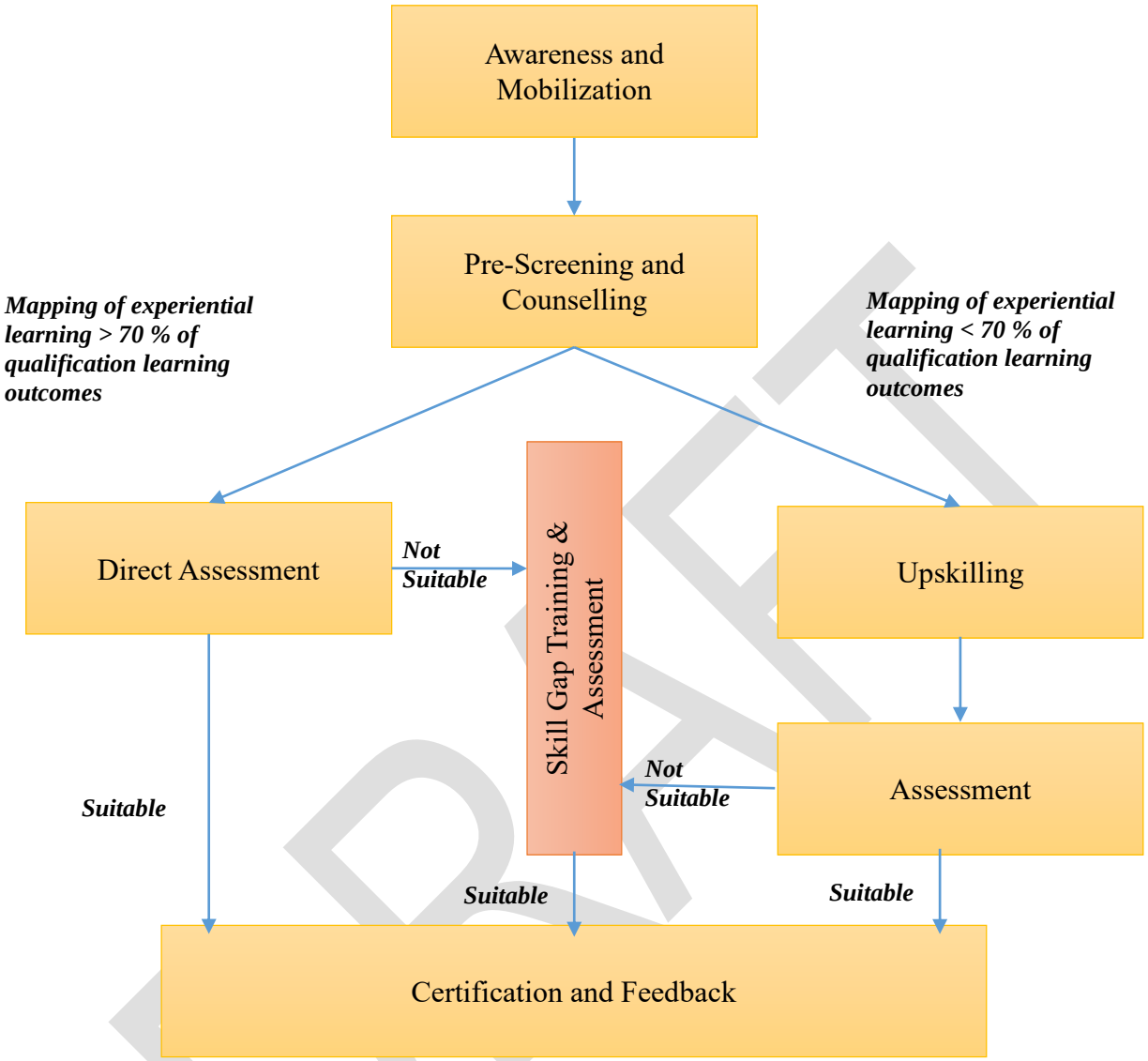
NCVET shall designate ownership of the guidelines to a consultant/ official/ team/ committee. The owner of the guidelines shall be given responsibility to make a record of all the challenges/ difficulties which would be faced during the implementation of the policy. Subsequently, these challenges/ difficulties shall be evaluated and a possible solution shall be provided with the approval of the Chairperson, NCVET.

All notifications required to be issued under the Guidelines to be issued with the approval of the Chairperson, NCVET. Urgent/ Minor modification required to be issued with the approval of the Chairperson, NCVET and to be got approved post facto by the Council. Interpretation of the Council regarding any of the provisions of the guidelines shall be final.

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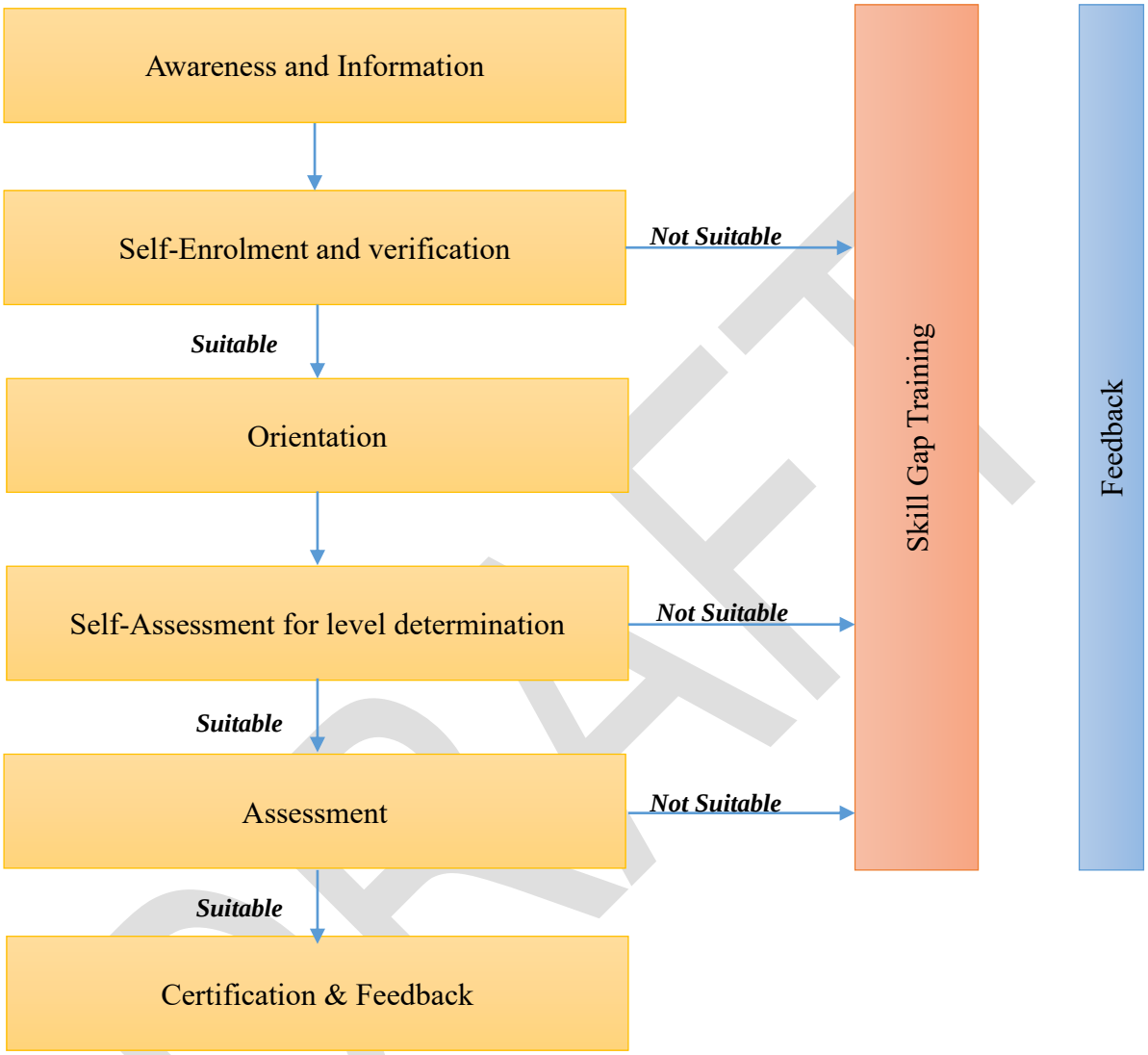
ANNEXURE – 1: RPL PROCESS FLOWCHART

Flowchart 1: RPL Process for NCrF/ NSQF level 1 to level 3.5



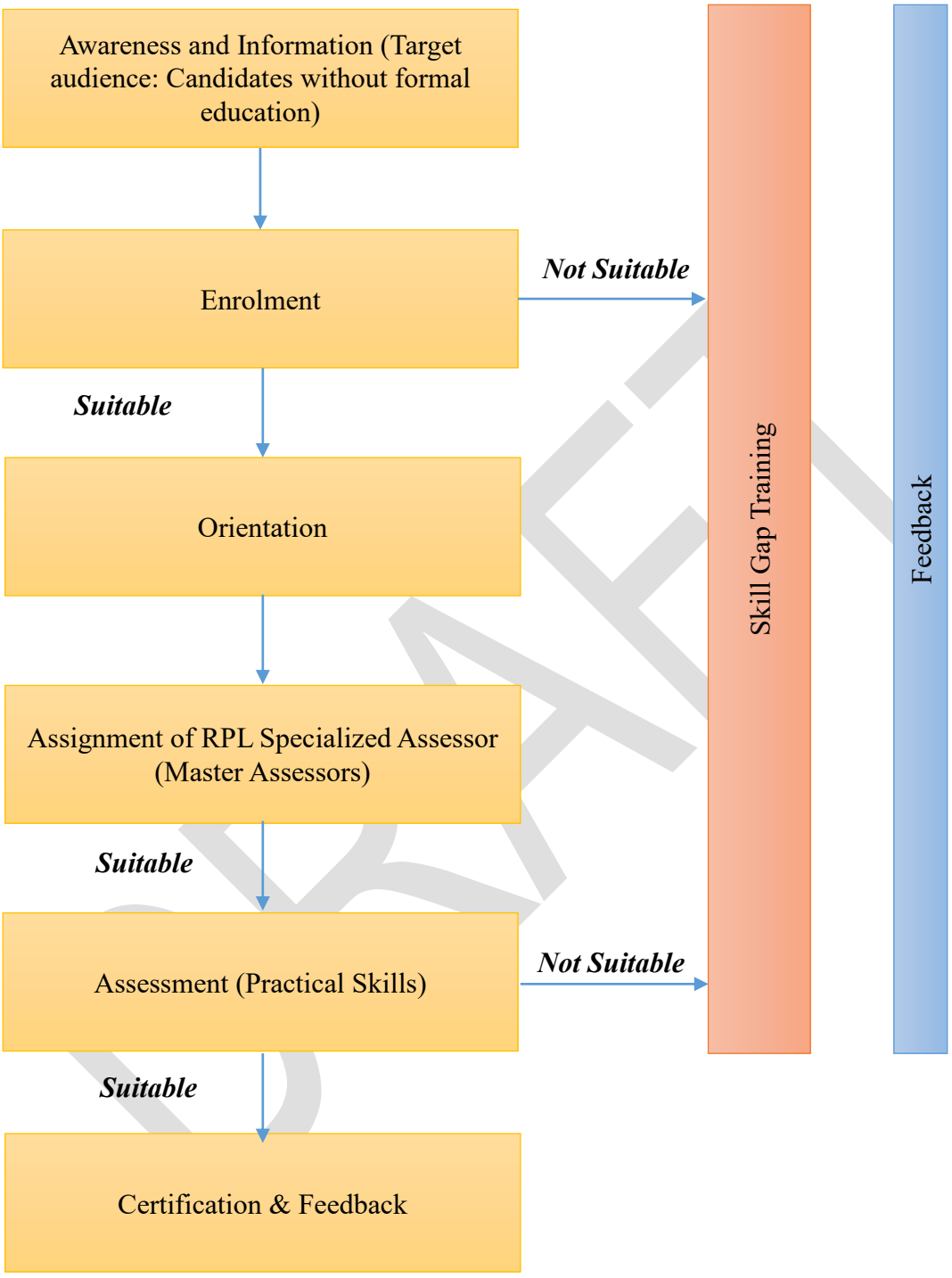
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Flowchart 2: RPL Process for NCrF/ NSQF level 4 to level 6 (12th With Exp, UG, PG pursuing)

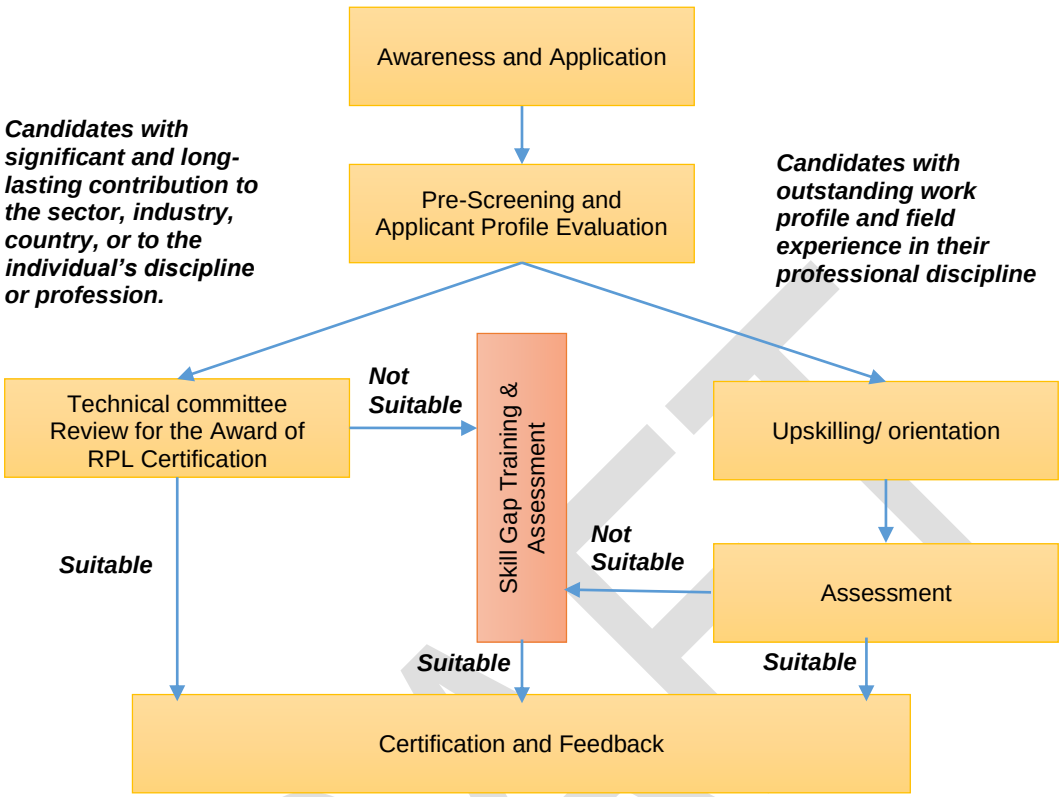


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Flowchart 3: RPL Process for NCrF/ NSQF level 4, 4.5, 5, 5.5, 6 (Without Formal education)



Flowchart 4: RPL Process for NCrF/ NSQF level 6.5 to 8 (at PG and PHD level)



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ANNEXURE – 2: THE VARIOUS USE-CASE ON THE DUAL ROLE OF ASSESSOR

Sl. No.	Use-Case/ illustration (Trainers as Assessors)
1.	Trainers* at ITI can assess the candidates.
2.	Trainers* at Training centres operated by defence forces
3.	Trainers* at Training centres operated by Skill Universities
4.	Trainers/ expert/ practitioner imparting traditional skills may also conduct assessment.
5.	Teachers*/ Trainers* can conduct both training and assessment
6.	Master of trade/ Master craftsmen can conduct both training and assessment
7.	Industrial Experts can conduct both training and assessment
8.	'Professor of Practice' can conduct both training and assessment
9.	

(*subject to the availability of NSQF certification on both trainer and assessor qualifications.)

Sl. No.	Use-Case (Assessors as Trainers)
1.	Assessor performing RPL assessment may act as a trainer and provide training on orientation course, NOS or micro-credential based course, etc.
2.	

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ANNEXURE – 3: HACKATHON BASED ASSESSMENTS

Hackathon Based Assessments

Hackathon provides a platform and encourages students to brainstorm, pitch concepts, form teams, plan projects and develop prototypes. The creativity, teamwork and problem solving unleashed in a short period of time through collaborative projects at hackathons often stimulates participants to engage more deeply in their professions and academic interests. While hackathons have gained popularity outside of classroom learning environments, they can also add rich layers of interactions to existing class activities. Below mentioned is the process flow for conducting Hackathon based assessments.

a. In this type of RPL the Organization will register for Hackathon based RPL (to be conducted either internally or externally).
b. Submission of a Problem statement that may have cross sectoral and/or multi sectoral NOSs/Skills
c. Hackathon to be aligned with standards (QP/NOS) created by AB, AB needs to be informed and approval needs to be taken.
d. AB to validate the alignment of problem statement with QP/NOS
e. Selection of Online or Offline mode by Delivery Partners (Academic Institutes/Organizations/ Training Partners etc.)
f. Awareness and Mobilization of the Hackathon though suitable channels by Delivery partners (Project Implementation Agencies/organizations/institutes etc.)
g. Hackathon Enrolment – To be reported to AB if Hackathon is approved by AB
h. Hackathon Execution as per organization's process and requirement.
i. Final result/score card of all participants to be shared with AB, only applicable if hackathon is approved by AB.
j. Joint Certification, if organization/institutes desire so, only for Hackathons that are approved by AB

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ANNEXURE - 4: TRADITIONAL (INDIGENOUS) SKILLS/ OCCUPATIONS AND ITS ASSESSMENT PROCESS

I. List of Indian Traditional Crafts/ Skills:

Sl. No.	Indian Traditional Crafts/ Skills	Examples
1.	Wooden work	• walnut wood carving, Pinjrakari & Khatumband in Kashmir • woodwork of Dharamshala • Kasta Kari of Goa • Lacquered wooden toys
2.	Stone Masonry	• Renowned craftsmanship of the Silavat communities of mason near Thar district. • Rubble masonry work
3.	Traditional Painting	• Warli paintings of Maharashtra • Rajasthani wall painting • wall and floor painters of Madhubani in Bihar • Pichhwai temple hangings • paintings in the Mithila region of Bihar • cloth paintings of Rajasthan • Mandala art • Chitrakathi & Ganjifa painting
4.	Metal Work	• traditional copperware of Kashmir • indigenous metalwork of Ladakh • Tibetan metalwork • Thattar ka Kaam- sheet metal work of Kullu • brassware of Moradabad • silver wares, damascening and metal engraving of Udaipur • Combination of ubharnaqqashi or repoussé with jaal ka kaam or openwork of Lucknow
5.	Textile	• Kashmir – Pashmina • HP – Kullu Shawls • UK- Panchachuli weave • Punjab/ Haryana – Phulkari, Panja Weave • Rajasthan – Shisha • Gujrat – Bandhani • Maharashtra – Paithani • Goa – Kunbi • Karnataka – Mysore Silk • Kerala – Kasavu • Tamil Nadu – Kanjeevaram Silk • Bihar – Bhagalpuri Silk • Orissa – Sambalpuri Saree • Nagaland – Naga Shawls
6.	Pottery	• Handmade pottery – bowls, jars, vessels – in various colours. • Khurja pottery, UP – Also known as ceramic city • Black Clay pottery - UP • Rajasthan's Molela - murthikala

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		• West Bengal – Terracotta Pottery • Gujarat – Khavda pottery • Karnataka – Bidriware
7.	Papier-Mache (Paper Pulp)	• craft of shaping and molding products from paper pulp • highly sophisticated papier-mâché tradition of the Kashmir Valley •
8.	Carpet Weaving	• The main carpet-producing areas of India are Srinagar in Kashmir, Jaipur in Rajasthan, Amritsar in Punjab, Mirzapur, and Agra in Uttar Pradesh. • Kashmir is most famous for hand-knotted and wool silk rugs • Nakaash is the person who designs the carper, a kalimba is a weaver and the ranger is the person who dyes the carpet.
9.	Traditional Dance	• Bharatanatyam is a classical dance from the South Indian state of Tamil Nadu • Kathakali is a highly stylized classical dance-drama form, which originated from Kerala. • Kathak (Northern India) • Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh) • Odissi (Odisha) • Sattriya (Assam) • Manipuri (Manipur) • Mohiniyattam (Kerala) • Folk and tribal dance forms (Garba, Bhangra & Giddha, Lavani, Ghoomar, etc.)
10.	Forest produce harvesting &value addition	
11.	Bamboo crafts	
12.	Culinary	
13.	Food processing	

II. Some of the Government Schemes for empowering Indian traditional handicrafts and artisans

Sl. No.	Name of Scheme/ program	Description
1.	Ambedkar Hastshilp Vikas Yojna	• the program enables community empowerment to mobilise artisans into self-help groups. • Under the design and technology upgradation subsection, a 25-day workshop is conducted to develop new prototypes to suit the tastes and preferences of contemporary markets, using the traditional skill of artisans, and introduce new techniques and technologies for enhanced production. • It provides support in the form of an integrated design and technology development project, assistance to exporters and entrepreneurs for design prototypes, and commercial market intelligence.

		• Also provides support in human resource development, infrastructure and technology support, healthcare, and more.
2.	Mega cluster scheme	• The program follows a mega cluster-based approach in scaling up infrastructural and production chains at handicraft centers that have remained unorganized and have not kept up with modernization and other developments. • The objectives include generating employment and improving living standards for existing artisans.
3.	Marketing support and services scheme	• Conduct craft awareness and demonstration programmes • provides interventions for domestic marketing events to artisans. • Assistance is also provided for hiring built-up space for events organised by other institutions. • Also assistance provided for compliance, social, and welfare needs for artisans • Assistance in publicity and brand promotion
4.	Research and development scheme	• To generate feedback on economic, social, aesthetic, and promotional aspects of various crafts and artisans in the sector. • Surveys and studies are conducted on specific crafts on which enough information is not easily available
5.	USTTAD (Upgrading the Skills and Training in Traditional Arts/ Crafts for Development)	• To build the capacity of master craftsmen/artisans and train the young generation through master craftsmen/artisans for traditional arts/crafts. • Set up standards of identified arts/crafts and their documentation. • To showcase traditional arts & crafts skills including culinary skills through exhibitions under the banner of Hunar Haat, which will also provide a platform for business opportunities and market linkages. • To preserve the rich heritage of the traditional arts and crafts of minorities. • To establish linkages of traditional skills with the global market. • To improve the employability of existing workers, school dropouts, etc. • To generate means of better livelihood for marginalized minorities and bring them in the mainstream. • To enable minorities to avail opportunities in the growing market. • To ensure the dignity of labor. • Design development and Research in traditional arts/crafts.
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III. Overall Challenges

a. Limited Awareness about Current Market Trends
b. No systematic Research and Development for New Product Development
c. lacking global appeal
d. Unprofessional Image - leads to inability to attract Corporate Finance
e. Irregular and volatile nature of demand for the products
f. Lack of infrastructural facilities
g. Limited use of machines & technology increases lead time, reduces quantity of production and increases prices
h. Lack of key information inputs like distribution network, market potential, competitive landscape etc.
i. Lack of continuous source of good quality raw materials
j. Family run units without professional management
k. Low education and poor economic background of the artisans
l. Complacent & egoistic attitude of the craftsmen prohibits them from accepting feedback & developing new products
m. Lack of Branding leads to Poor Product Image and thereby reduces scope of charging premium prices

IV. Challenges in skilling/ training/ assessment for the traditional skills/ occupations

a. Identification of job roles/ occupation as most of them are from unorganized sector.
b. Estimation of number of workforce involved in the particular traditional job role/ occupation.
c. Non-availability of qualifications/ courses for the traditional skills in the formal education system.
d. Mobilization of candidate for the training, as most of traditional skills/ occupations is non-aspirational.
e. Lack of infrastructure for the skilling activities (training and assessments)
f. Lack of trainers/ assessors for the traditional skills.

V. Strategy for imparting skill training/ assessment for traditional skills

a. Identification of traditional skilled-based clusters.
b. Occupational and functional analysis for the identification of the job roles and development of the NOSs/ qualifications. The NOS/ qualifications shall be designed in a manner to preserve traditional arts/ crafts by mixing the traditional with modern ideas/ technologies/ methods and making the artisan more employment ready under the same traditional craft.
c. Development of upskilling/ reskilling NOSs to make artisans understand about customer demand, and development of customer/market for their product.
d. Identification and mobilization of potential candidates for skilling/ assessment.
e. Sensitizing the artisans/ candidates on the history, ideology and relevance of a craft.
f. Mapping the learning outcomes of the NOS/ qualification with the competencies of the candidates/ artisans, and determining their NCrF/ NSQC level. Based on the tentative NCrF/ NSQC level, the RPL assessment of the candidate/ artisan shall be conducted (refer RPL guidelines, section 4, for detailed process).

VI. Assessor engaged for the assessment for traditional skills

The Master Trainers/ Master Assessors who are well known Master Craftsmen/ Artisans in the selected field of traditional art/ craft shall be engaged for the assessment of traditional skills. The National/ State Awardee Master Craftsmen/ Artisans, and National Merit Certificate Holders are to be given preference as assessors.

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